

EVIDENCE AXIS

ACTUALYZE AI — EVIDENCE APPENDIX

Public evidence reviewed 30 August 2026

Scope. This appendix supports the eight-slide Executive Deck. It tests a narrow public-evidence question: whether Actualyze may face category-discovery friction, security-platform consolidation pressure, and deployment-eligibility friction before a buyer reaches feature-level evaluation. Public sources only; no internal roadmap, pipeline, win/loss, customer interviews, product access or private procurement data were used.

Evidence labels

Label	Meaning
FACT — primary	Directly stated by the company, product, legal or transaction source.
FACT — independent	Reported or analyzed by a non-vendor publication, analyst or buyer/review platform.
OBSERVED	A page-scan result recorded on the review date; dynamic and not proof of buyer behavior.
INFERENCE	Evidence Axis interpretation drawn from the cited facts; not presented as fact.
GUARDRAIL	A boundary that prevents overstatement or false equivalence.
UNKNOWN	Cannot be established from the public evidence reviewed.

Working conclusion

FACT: Actualyze launched from stealth on 3 Aug 2026 with a hosted early-access control plane positioned between applications/agents and model providers. Public buyer-category surfaces already list AI Gateway products including Prisma AIRS/Portkey and Cloudflare.

INFERENCE: Actualyze may need to solve three pre-demo problems: being discovered in the category, answering a consolidation objection from security-platform buyers, and qualifying deployment-constrained enterprises before feature comparison.

UNKNOWN: Whether any of these issues currently cause lost pipeline, whether buyers use the reviewed directories in actual deals, and which buyer segments accept Hosted Early Access today.

1. Source register

ID	Source class	Source	Date	URL	Use in analysis
A1	Actualize primary	Actualize AI homepage / product surface	Current; checked 30 Aug 2026	Open source	Positioning; one governed path; Hosted Early Access; On-Prem 2027; routing, guardrails, budget and audit claims.
A2	Company release	Actualize emerges from stealth; \$7M seed	3 Aug 2026	Open source	Launch trigger; one platform for every AI request; hosted platform in Early Access.
A3	Independent publication / interview	R&D World — Actualize AI targets enterprise AI sprawl	5 Aug 2026	Open source	Independent competitive context; names Portkey/PANW, Cloudflare, Kong, LiteLLM and hyperscaler controls.
T1	Independent buyer/review platform	TrustRadius — Best AI Gateways 2026	Current; checked 30 Aug 2026	Open source	Defines buyer category, deployment options and current listed products; Prisma AIRS/Portkey and Cloudflare present.
G1	Independent peer-review marketplace	Gartner Peer Insights — AI Gateways	Current; checked 30 Aug 2026	Open source	Defines AI Gateway market and returned 27 products in reviewed page state.
P1	Palo Alto Networks primary	Intent to acquire Portkey	30 Apr 2026	Open source	Acquisition intent; Portkey to serve as AI Gateway for Prisma AIRS.
P2	Palo Alto Networks primary	Portkey acquisition completed	29 May 2026	Open source	Deal closed; Portkey core AI Gateway for Prisma AIRS; PANW boilerplate states 70,000+ customers.
P3	Palo Alto Networks primary	Prisma AIRS AI Gateway product / GA page	Current; GA 16 Jul 2026	Open source	AI control-plane positioning; Universal API; >3000 LLMs/MCP servers/tools; governance and runtime controls; GA date.
PK1	Competitor primary	Portkey Enterprise hybrid deployment architecture	Last modified 2 Mar 2026; checked 30 Aug	Open source	Data Plane in customer VPC; AI traffic and sensitive LLM data stay inside customer environment; configurable log location.
CF1	Competitor primary	Cloudflare AI Gateway features	Updated 5 Jun 2026	Open source	Spend limits; Dynamic Routing; Guardrails; DLP; Authentication; 20+ supported AI providers.
CF2	Competitor primary	Cloudflare AI Gateway changelog	5 Jun 2026 entry	Open source	Spend-limit release timing and scope by model/provider/custom metadata.
NS1	Independent publication	The New Stack — Palo Alto / Portkey AI Gateway	4 May 2026	Open source	Places Portkey, LiteLLM, Kong AI Gateway and Cloudflare AI Gateway in the same fragmentation problem set; analyzes security-control-point shift.
N1	Independent analyst	NAND Research — Portkey acquisition anchors agentic security stack	4 May 2026	Open source	Platform-consolidation logic; says stack appeals to large enterprises consolidating security vendors.
F1	Independent analyst	Futurum — Can PANW route the agentic future through Portkey?	7 May 2026	Open source	Gateway as traffic-layer control point; platformization economics; incremental value for enterprises standardized on PANW.

2. Claim-level matrix

Claim	Class	Source IDs	Client-facing wording discipline
Actualize uses 'foundation for enterprise AI' / 'control plane' language and the reviewed homepage text did not use the phrase 'AI Gateway'.	OBSERVED / FACT	A1	Can state as a page-scan result. Do not claim deliberate avoidance or SEO failure.
Actualize offers one endpoint, budgets/policies, PII controls, routing/failover, audit and chargeback-style cost attribution in the request path.	FACT — primary	A1, A2	Use to map the product to the AI Gateway buying job; not proof of parity with any comparator.
TrustRadius currently lists Prisma AIRS AI Gateway (Portkey) and Cloudflare AI Gateway in its AI Gateways category; Actualize was not observed in the reviewed product list.	OBSERVED	T1	Snapshot only. Absence is not proof of lost pipeline or analyst exclusion.
Gartner Peer Insights returned 27 AI Gateway products in the reviewed market page; Actualize was not observed in that returned page state.	OBSERVED	G1	Dynamic page. Use as a discovery-surface signal, not a market-share conclusion.
R&D World independently frames Actualize as entering a crowded category and names Palo Alto/Portkey, Cloudflare, Kong and LiteLLM.	FACT — independent	A3	Important negative control: do not sell competitor-name discovery as the headline insight.
PANW announced intent on 30 Apr, closed Portkey on 29 May, and made Prisma AIRS AI Gateway GA on 16 Jul 2026.	FACT — primary	P1, P2, P3	Can state directly.
PANW's current AI Gateway page states secure access to more than 3000 LLMs, MCP servers and tools through a Universal API.	FACT — primary	P3	Do not shorten to '3000 models' because tools/MCP servers are included.
PANW states 70,000+ customers in the acquisition press-release boilerplate.	FACT — primary / company claim	P2	Use as distribution context, not as AI Gateway customer count.
Independent analysts describe the Portkey move as consistent with platformization / consolidation for enterprises already standardized on Palo Alto Networks.	FACT — independent / analysis	N1, F1	Supports the procurement-path inference; does not prove a specific Actualize objection is occurring.
Portkey docs show the Data Plane running inside the customer VPC with sensitive LLM data and AI traffic staying in the customer environment.	FACT — competitor primary	PK1	Architecture fact; do not attribute it to PANW unless separately sourced.
Actualize public material shows Hosted Early Access today and On-Prem in 2027.	FACT — primary	A1, A2	Roadmap timing may change; label 2027 as current public plan.
TrustRadius buyer guidance treats managed SaaS, VPC, self-hosted and air-gapped deployment as category selection dimensions.	FACT — independent	T1	Supports deployment model as a buyer criterion, not proof every buyer requires private deployment.
Cloudflare features include spend limits, routing, guardrails, DLP, authentication and 20+ supported AI providers.	FACT — competitor primary	CF1, CF2	Category-floor evidence; do not claim full parity with Actualize or Prisma AIRS.
Cloudflare and current Prisma AIRS/Portkey belong in the same live AI Gateway competitive set.	FACT — independent classification	NS1, T1	\$4.5 support. The New Stack provides 2026 competitive framing; TrustRadius provides live current category co-listing.

3. Finding 1 — The category exists without Actualyze in it

Finding statement: Actualyze publicly fits the AI Gateway buying job, while two live buyer-category surfaces reviewed on 30 Aug 2026 did not visibly list Actualyze even though established gateway products were already present.

Evidence point	Source	Classification
Actualyze sits in the inference path and exposes one governed endpoint with policy, budget, guardrail, routing/failover and audit controls.	A1, A2	FACT — primary
The reviewed homepage uses 'foundation' and 'control plane' language; the phrase 'AI Gateway' was not observed in the page text.	A1	OBSERVED
TrustRadius defines AI gateways around runtime intermediation, routing/failover, policy, spend allocation and governed access; it lists Prisma AIRS AI Gateway (Portkey) and Cloudflare AI Gateway.	T1	FACT — independent / OBSERVED
Actualyze was not observed in the TrustRadius listed products reviewed on 30 Aug 2026.	T1	OBSERVED
Gartner Peer Insights defines AI gateways as an intermediary/control point for access, security, governance and observability; its reviewed page returned 27 products.	G1	FACT — independent / OBSERVED
Actualyze was not observed in the Gartner Peer Insights page state reviewed on 30 Aug 2026.	G1	OBSERVED
R&D World already names PANW/Portkey, Cloudflare, Kong and LiteLLM around Actualyze; competitor awareness itself is therefore not treated as the new insight.	A3	FACT — independent
The useful decision is to test category visibility, not to assume the founder is unaware of the field.	A1, A3, T1, G1	INFERENCE

Guardrail

Allowed: Actualyze was not observed on the reviewed directory/market surfaces on 30 Aug 2026 and may benefit from testing secondary AI Gateway category language. **Not allowed:** Actualyze is missing from every buyer database; buyers cannot find the company; the absence caused lost deals; directory listing alone will improve conversion.

Decision interpretation

INFERENCE. Because Actualyze launched only on 3 Aug, the absence can be a normal lag rather than a positioning failure. The low-regret action is a controlled category-copy and buyer-surface visibility test, with demo quality and source attribution tracked before changing the broader 'foundation for enterprise AI' narrative.

4. Finding 2 — The procurement path changed after Portkey moved inside Palo Alto

Finding statement: The important change is not the acquisition headline itself. It is that a buyer already standardized on Palo Alto can evaluate an AI Gateway as an extension of an existing security platform rather than as a new standalone vendor decision.

Evidence point	Source	Classification
Palo Alto announced intent to acquire Portkey on 30 Apr 2026 and said Portkey would serve as the AI Gateway for Prisma AIRS.	P1	FACT — primary
Palo Alto completed the acquisition on 29 May 2026 and established Portkey as the core AI Gateway for Prisma AIRS.	P2	FACT — primary
Prisma AIRS AI Gateway became generally available on 16 Jul 2026.	P3	FACT — primary
PANW's current page positions Prisma AIRS AI Gateway as the enterprise AI control plane with governance, identity and runtime controls.	P3	FACT — primary
The Universal API is described as providing secure access to more than 3000 LLMs, MCP servers and tools.	P3	FACT — primary
PANW's acquisition-release boilerplate states the company is trusted by 70,000+ customers.	P2	FACT — primary / company claim
NAND Research says the combined stack is designed to appeal to large enterprises consolidating security vendors and provides a consolidation opportunity for customers already on PANW.	N1	FACT — independent analysis
Futurum says the addition represents incremental value for enterprises already standardized on Palo Alto Networks and fits the company's platformization thesis.	F1	FACT — independent analysis
Therefore a security-led enterprise may ask why it should add a new AI control-plane vendor instead of extending the security platform it already operates.	P2, P3, N1, F1	INFERENCE

Guardrail

Allowed: The acquisition and GA create a credible consolidation route for PANW customers. **Not allowed:** Every PANW customer will choose Prisma AIRS; Actualize cannot win security-led enterprises; Prisma AIRS is cheaper; or 70,000+ customers are AI Gateway customers.

Decision interpretation

INFERENCE. A feature-by-feature battlecard is insufficient if the objection is procurement simplicity. Actualize needs a defensible reason that an independent, vendor-neutral control plane is worth introducing as another strategic vendor.

5. Finding 3 — Deployment can become an eligibility gate before product comparison

Finding statement: Actualyze publicly offers Hosted Early Access now and On-Prem in 2027. The AI Gateway category itself treats deployment model as a selection dimension, while Portkey already documents a customer-VPC Data Plane.

Evidence point	Source	Classification
Actualyze says Hosted is Early Access and open today.	A1, A2	FACT — primary
Actualyze says On-Prem is coming in 2027, deployed entirely inside the customer's environment for data residency and air-gapped operation.	A1	FACT — primary
Portkey's hybrid architecture states the Data Plane runs within the customer VPC and keeps sensitive LLM data and AI traffic in that environment.	PK1	FACT — competitor primary
Portkey documents local log-storage options in the customer environment for high-security deployments.	PK1	FACT — competitor primary
TrustRadius buyer guidance lists managed SaaS, VPC, self-hosted and air-gapped environments as AI Gateway deployment options to evaluate.	T1	FACT — independent
A buyer with a hard VPC/self-hosted/air-gap requirement can therefore reject a Hosted-only option before comparing routing, guardrails or spend controls.	A1, PK1, T1	INFERENCE

Guardrail

Allowed: Deployment model can be a first-pass criterion, and Actualyze's public On-Prem path is currently future-dated. **Not allowed:** Most enterprises require VPC; Actualyze is non-compliant; Hosted is unsuitable for regulated industries; or Portkey is equivalent to Actualyze across product scope.

Attribution note

The VPC/Data Plane architecture claim is sourced to Portkey documentation. Palo Alto sources are used for acquisition, integration, current Prisma AIRS positioning and GA—not as the sole source for the Portkey hybrid-architecture claim.

6. Cloudflare — category-floor evidence, not a parity claim

Why it is included: Cloudflare is used to show that several governance/cost/security functions are becoming category baseline capabilities. It is not presented as a like-for-like substitute for Actualyze.

Evidence point	Source	Classification
Cloudflare AI Gateway Features page is marked last updated 5 Jun 2026.	CF1	FACT — primary
Spend limits can be scoped by model, provider or custom metadata such as user, team or application.	CF1, CF2	FACT — primary
Dynamic Routing supports visual routing without code changes and automatic fallbacks.	CF1	FACT — primary
Guardrails, DLP and Authentication are documented security features.	CF1	FACT — primary
Cloudflare states these features work across 20+ supported AI providers.	CF1	FACT — primary
The New Stack's 4 May 2026 analysis places Portkey, LiteLLM, Kong AI Gateway and Cloudflare AI Gateway in the same fragmentation problem set.	NS1	FACT — independent
TrustRadius' current 2026 AI Gateway category lists both Prisma AIRS AI Gateway (Portkey) and Cloudflare AI Gateway.	T1	FACT — independent / OBSERVED
These two independent 2026 sources support current competitive-set membership for Cloudflare under the Evidence Axis scan rule.	NS1, T1	INFERENCE / validation

Guardrail

Allowed: The feature floor is rising across the AI Gateway category. **Not allowed:** Cloudflare equals Actualyze, has the same enterprise governance depth, shares the same deployment model, or should be treated as the primary competitor in every deal.

7. Decision interpretation used in the Executive Deck

Observed movement	Evidence Axis interpretation
Actualize fits the AI Gateway runtime buying job but was not observed on two reviewed buyer-category surfaces.	Test whether secondary AI Gateway language and directory/profile coverage improve qualified discovery without narrowing the broader enterprise-AI story.
Portkey is now a GA Prisma AIRS AI Gateway inside Palo Alto's platformization motion.	Build the Prisma AIRS battlecard around procurement and vendor-neutrality, not a generic feature checklist.
Actualize is Hosted Early Access now; public On-Prem timing is 2027; Portkey documents customer-VPC deployment.	Segment Hosted-fit prospects from private-deployment-blocked prospects before long sales cycles begin.
Cloudflare shows spend, routing, guardrail, DLP and auth functions in a broad platform gateway.	Treat these functions as a rising feature floor; keep differentiation focused on durable control-plane value rather than possession of a checklist.

Unknowns that remain

- Whether Actualize is already submitted to, pending review at, or intentionally absent from any buyer directory.
- Which discovery sources produce qualified pipeline for Actualize today.
- How often Prisma AIRS appears in real Actualize opportunities, and whether the objection is security consolidation, feature depth, price, procurement or something else.
- Which regulated or large-enterprise prospects currently require VPC, self-hosted or air-gapped deployment.
- Whether Actualize has private deployment options or design-partner exceptions not published on the reviewed site.
- Actual win/loss overlap, buyer reaction to category language, and the conversion effect of any directory/profile changes.

Client-facing wording lock

	Wording
Use	"category-discovery risk," "procurement-path pressure," "deployment eligibility," "may," "worth testing," "not observed in the reviewed page state."
Avoid	"Actualize is invisible," "buyers will miss you," "Prisma AIRS will win," "Cloudflare has parity," "regulated enterprises cannot buy Hosted," "directory absence proves lost pipeline."

Method note

All material factual claims in this appendix were mapped to sources opened during the research/review process. Vendor-authored sources establish what each vendor publicly says about its own product; they are not treated as neutral proof of superiority. Dynamic directory absence is recorded as an OBSERVED page-scan result, not as a durable market fact.